Winston Chou

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EMPLOYMENT

Netflix **New York, NY**
Staff Research Scientist, AI Strategy & Innovation *2022 –*

- Designed north star metric used to decide all personalization A/B tests at Netflix. Best Paper at KDD '25.
- Developed methodology and AI workflows for causal inference platform (ECML PKDD '26, Netflix).
- Ran experiments to calibrate user choice models and optimize Netflix's content budget (IJIO).
- Promoted from Senior (L5) to Staff (L6) in 2024.

Apple **New York, NY**
Staff Data Scientist, AIML *2020 – 2022*

- Designed, executed, and analyzed the first A/B tests on the Siri voice assistant.
- Wrote performant statistical software for analyzing experiments on 250m+ devices.
- Promoted from Senior (ICT4) to Staff (ICT5) in 2021.

Facebook **New York, NY**
Research Scientist, Statistics & Privacy R&D *2018 – 2020*

- Drove statistical models for imputing missing data in advertising measurement from R&D to launch.
- Partnered with global engineering teams to implement statistical models in production.

EDUCATION

Princeton University **Princeton, NJ**
PhD, Political Science *2019*

SKILLS

- *Causal inference and experimentation.* Experiment design and analysis, experimentation platforms, meta-analysis, causal machine learning, observational causal inference
- *Statistics and machine learning.* Regression analysis, hierarchical models, Bayesian statistics, maximum likelihood estimation, missing data, variance reduction, data visualization
- *Statistical computing.* Python, R, Spark, SQL, Stan, PyMC

SELECTED RESEARCH

[1] "The value of personalized recommendations: Evidence from Netflix," with Kevin Zielnicki, Guy Aridor, Aurélien Bibaut, Allen Tran, and Nathan Kallus. *International Journal of Industrial Organization*. Presented at *NBER Digital Economics and AI Meeting* and *ACM Conference on Economics and Computation '26*.

[2] "Estimating representative causal effects with double machine learning," with Apoorva Lal. *European Conference on Machine Learning & Principles and Practice of Knowledge Discovery in Databases (ECML PKDD '26).*

[3] "Blending proxy metrics with a north star." *ECML PKDD '26.*

[4] "Evaluating decision rules across many weak experiments," with Colin Gray, Nathan Kallus, Aurélien Bibaut, and Simon Ejdemyr. *KDD '25: Proceedings of the 31st ACM SIGKDD Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining.* **Best Paper Award (Applied Data Science).** Netflix TechBlog post.

[5] "Learning the covariance of treatment effects across many weak experiments," with Aurélien Bibaut, Simon Ejdemyr, and Nathan Kallus. *KDD '24: Proceedings of the 30th ACM SIGKDD Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining.* Netflix TechBlog post.